

The Morning: Born American

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The New York Times
The Morning

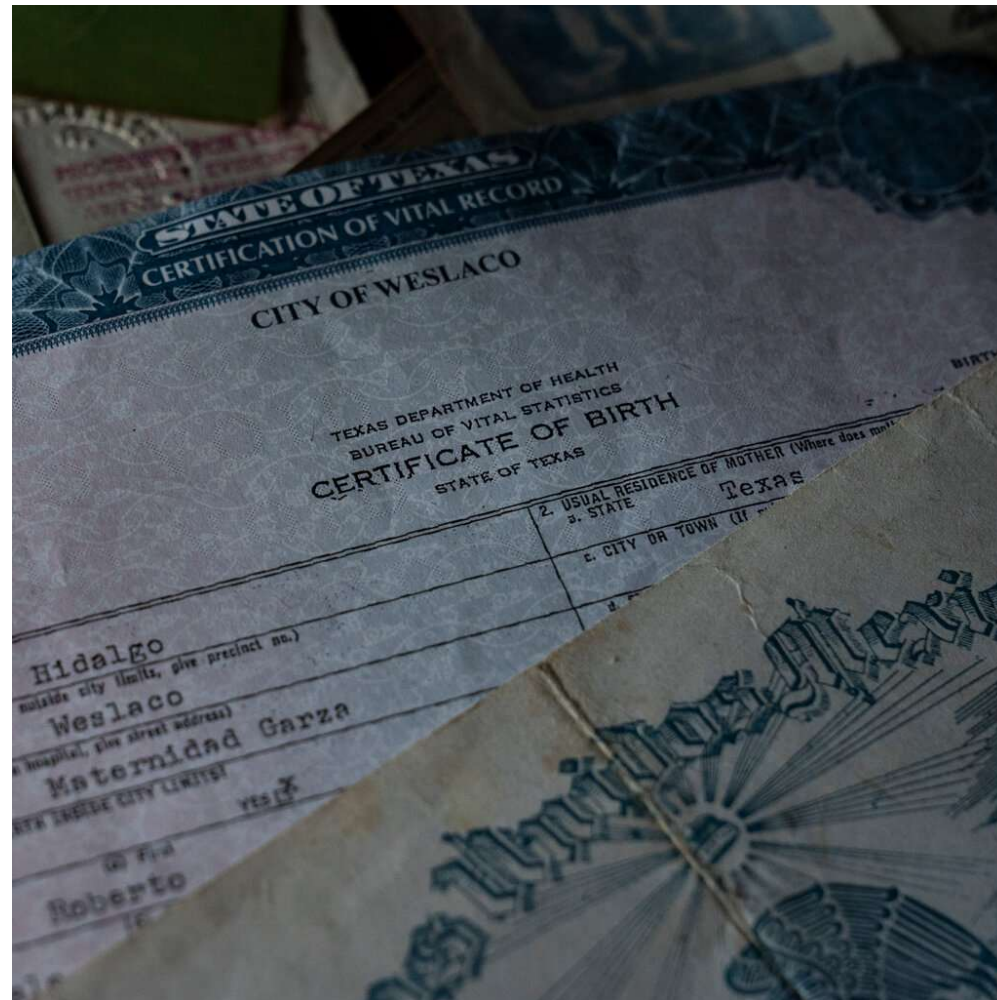
April 1, 2026



By Sam Sifton

Good morning. Passover begins at sunset. If you’re celebrating, I hope you have a meaningful Seder. (Either way, be careful: It’s April Fools’ Day.)

Now, onto the news. President Trump said the U.S. could be out of Iran in [a few weeks](#). He plans to address the nation tonight. A federal judge [stopped construction](#) on the new White House ballroom. And today, there is a major case before the Supreme Court.



Gabriel V. Cárdenas for The New York Times

Born American

In a few hours the Supreme Court will hear arguments over President Trump's plan to limit birthright citizenship. The case stems from an executive order Trump issued on his first day back in the White House meant to nullify a

longstanding rule that granted citizenship to babies born in the United States, even if their parents were not citizens or permanent residents. That order was swiftly challenged in court and blocked by lower courts.

Now the Supreme Court will consider whether the order is constitutional — meaning, does it square with the citizenship clause of the 14th Amendment?

That clause is the amendment's first sentence:

“All persons born or naturalized in the United States, and subject to the jurisdiction thereof, are citizens of the United States and of the State wherein they reside.”

It was adopted in 1868, to reverse part of the court's 1857 decision in *Dred Scott v. Sandford*, which had held that Black people of African descent were not and could not become U.S. citizens. The language appears pretty clear.

But mind this subclause of the clause carefully: “*and subject to the jurisdiction thereof.*” What those words mean will fuel the arguments of both the Trump administration and its challengers — lawyers representing children across the nation who would be affected.

For the administration

For more than 125 years, courts have interpreted “subject to the jurisdiction” as meaning nearly everyone born on U.S. soil. (There's a narrow exception for the children of foreign diplomats and the children of enemy occupiers.)

The Trump view, though, is that children of undocumented immigrants aren't subject to U.S. jurisdiction. Why? Among other reasons, the revisionists say, it's because their parents don't owe allegiance to the U.S. but instead to the nations

they left. Children of undocumented immigrants, they say, should thus be treated as we treat the diplomats' children — born on U.S. soil, but under the flag of a foreign nation.

Some conservative legal experts told The Times that the case [might be closer to call than once thought](#). One of them said, “We had seen enough to convince us that this question was not open-and-shut, that conventional wisdom may not be correct and that the Trump E.O. has more going for it than people realized.”



What to watch for

The opposing view is that birthright citizenship is a matter of settled law and has nothing to do with the parents of the children who receive it. There's no language about parents in the 14th Amendment. The Immigration and Nationality Act of 1952 mentions them only in the context of citizen children born outside the U.S. Both the amendment and the law use the same language: Anyone "born in the United States, and subject to the jurisdiction thereof," is a citizen.

Adam Liptak, our chief legal affairs correspondent, [wrote about that recently](#): "Whatever might have been the original meaning of the 14th Amendment, there is substantial evidence — in judicial decisions, legislative reports and executive practice — that Congress understood the 1952 law to guarantee birthright citizenship."

So yesterday I asked Adam what he'll be watching most closely. Here's what he told me:

We'll know whether the administration has a prayer of prevailing based on the early questions from the ideological middle of the court — the chief justice and the three Trump appointees. If they pepper the administration's lawyer with skeptical questions, which seems likely, it will be a good bet that Trump's long-shot revisionist theory is doomed.

If they treat the lawyer's arguments as presenting difficult problems of constitutional interpretation, the end of June, when

the court issues the biggest decisions of the term, will be interesting.

([Sign up for The Docket](#), Adam's newsletter, which demystifies matters of law and justice.)

A history of immigrants

One last thing before court. As the justices prepared to hear this landmark case today, reporters for The Times took a close look at their family histories. In each, the reporters found newcomers to America — colonists, enslaved people and immigrants alike — who paved the way for a descendant to ascend to the highest court in the land.

“These nine men and women will now sit in judgment of citizenship for their fellow countrymen,” they wrote.

It's a remarkable bit of journalism, built out of immigration and census records, ship manifests, biographies, memoirs and speeches related to the justices' families, well worth reading as we wait for the arguments to commence. [You can find it here.](#)

More from the courts

The Supreme Court, siding with a Christian therapist, [rejected a Colorado law that banned “conversion therapy.”](#)

A Trump administration's [demand for a list of Jews](#) at the University of Pennsylvania was legal, a judge ruled.



THE LATEST NEWS

War in the Mideast



In Tehran on Monday. Arash Khamooshi for The New York Times

Trump said that Iran was no longer a nuclear threat, but [there is no evidence](#) that is true.

The U.S. military [began flying B-52 bombers over Iran](#), Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth said. It's a sign the U.S. has control of Iran's skies.

Hegseth said U.S. bombers had [struck the Iranian city of Isfahan](#), after Trump shared a video of explosions.

Israel's defense minister outlined [plans to occupy much of southern Lebanon](#), meaning troops could remain even after the war ends.

Trump [lashed out again at European allies](#), telling Britain, “Go get your own oil.”

An American journalist [was kidnapped in Baghdad](#).

Narges Mohammadi, a Nobel Peace Prize laureate, has been denied outside treatment after [she had a heart attack in an Iranian prison](#), her husband said.

More on Politics

Trump signed an executive order that directs Homeland Security to create a “state citizenship list” [to determine voting eligibility](#).

A Trump administration panel voted [to lift protections on endangered species](#) in the Gulf of Mexico. It was the first such decision in over 30 years.

Trump released a video of his [planned presidential library in Miami](#). It has a golden escalator.

Around the World



At Windsor Castle last year. Doug Mills/The New York Times

Britain: Buckingham Palace confirmed that King Charles would [make his first official state visit to the U.S.](#) this month.

Indonesia: The government has accused Google and Meta of [failing to comply with its law](#) barring kids under 16 from social media.

Russia: People are using paper maps and landlines to cope with government-enforced internet blackouts. In the video below, Valerie

Hopkins, a Times correspondent, describes what's happening. **Click to play.**

Moscow
March 14, 2026

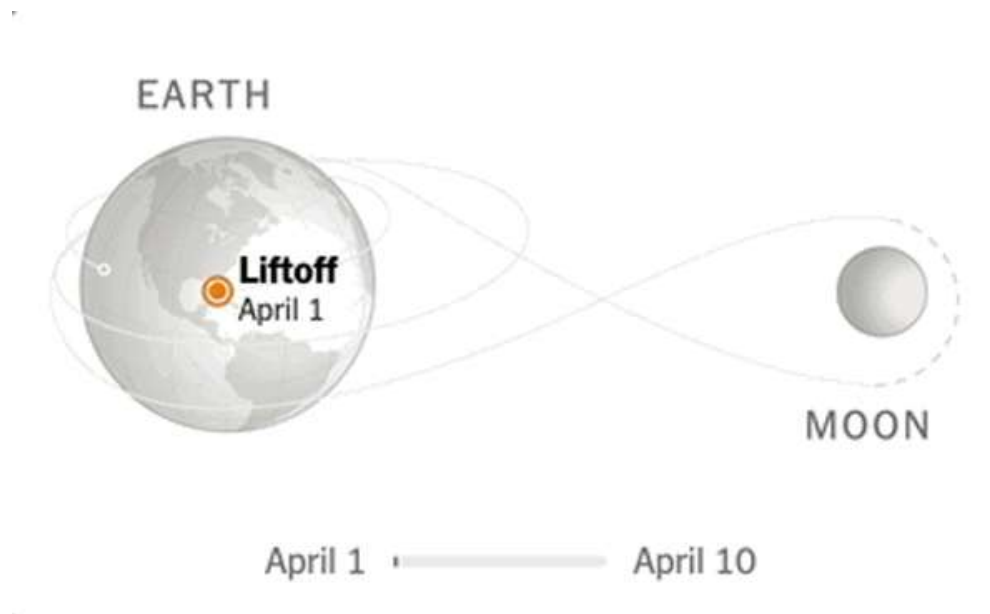


But lately, the internet connection
itself has been cutting off.



[Click to watch the video.](#) The New York Times

TO THE MOON



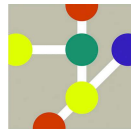
Marco Hernandez/The New York Times

Tonight, if the weather holds, the Artemis II mission will blast off from Florida, carrying humans around the moon for the first time in more than 50 years.

What's happening? Four astronauts will spend 10 days in a spacecraft with about as much interior space as two minivans. They'll test the capsule for future missions, including some that could return humans to the moon's surface. If the astronauts fly around the far side of the moon, they will be farther from Earth than a human has ever been.

Who are the astronauts? They're military pilots, engineers and [all-around achievers](#).

[Read more about the mission](#). And [listen to "The Daily,"](#) which is about the launch.



Want more Artemis?

Science Times, our science newsletter, will be covering the mission over the next two weeks.

[*Get it in your inbox*](#)

OPINIONS

Congress owes it to troops [to hold the Trump administration accountable](#) for the war in the Mideast, write **Chuck Hagel** and **Leon Panetta**, former defense secretaries.

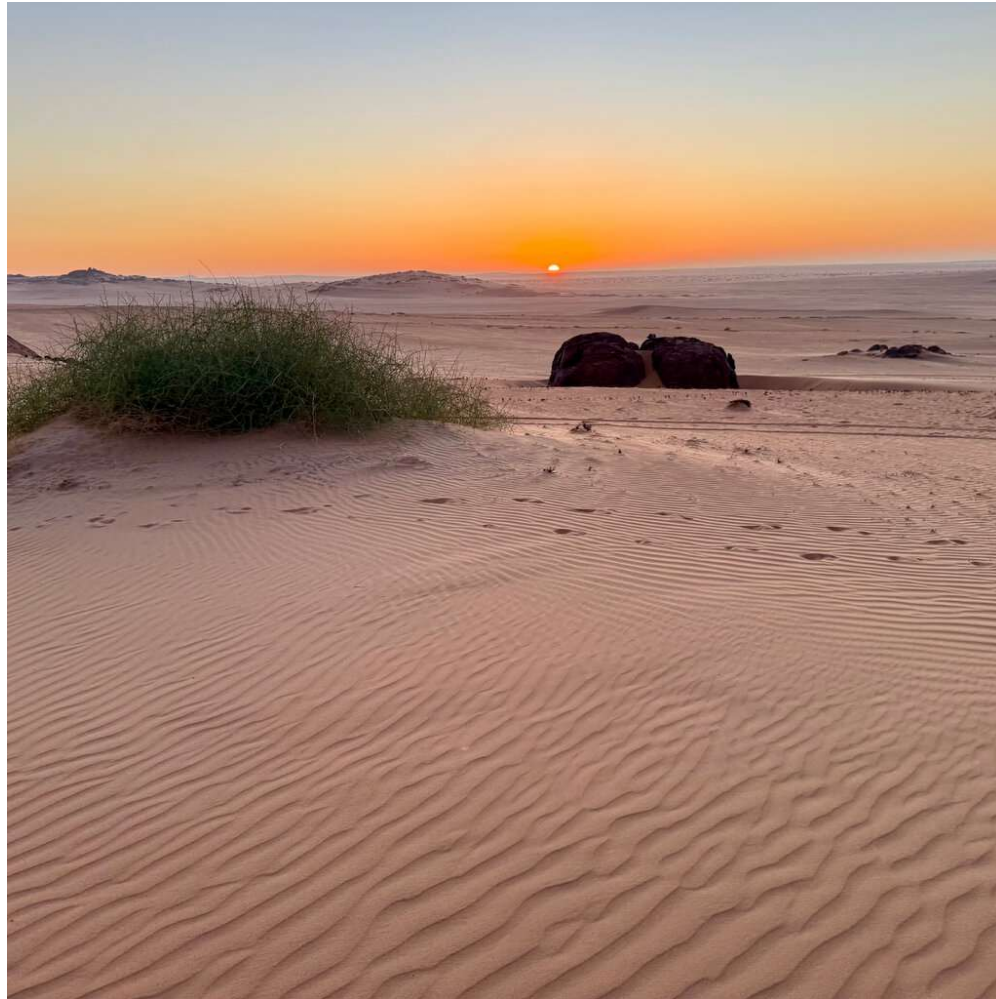
Birthright citizenship “gets at the heart of American values and culture,”
Padma Lakshmi writes, and [the Supreme Court should uphold it](#).

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MORNING READS



Ginanne Brownell

In the dunes: On Namibia's Skeleton Coast, a writer found a blank canvas of constantly shifting sands. [See more of the beautiful landscape.](#)

Hot dogs: Inflation is making Iceland's beloved snack more expensive. [People are still ordering it.](#)

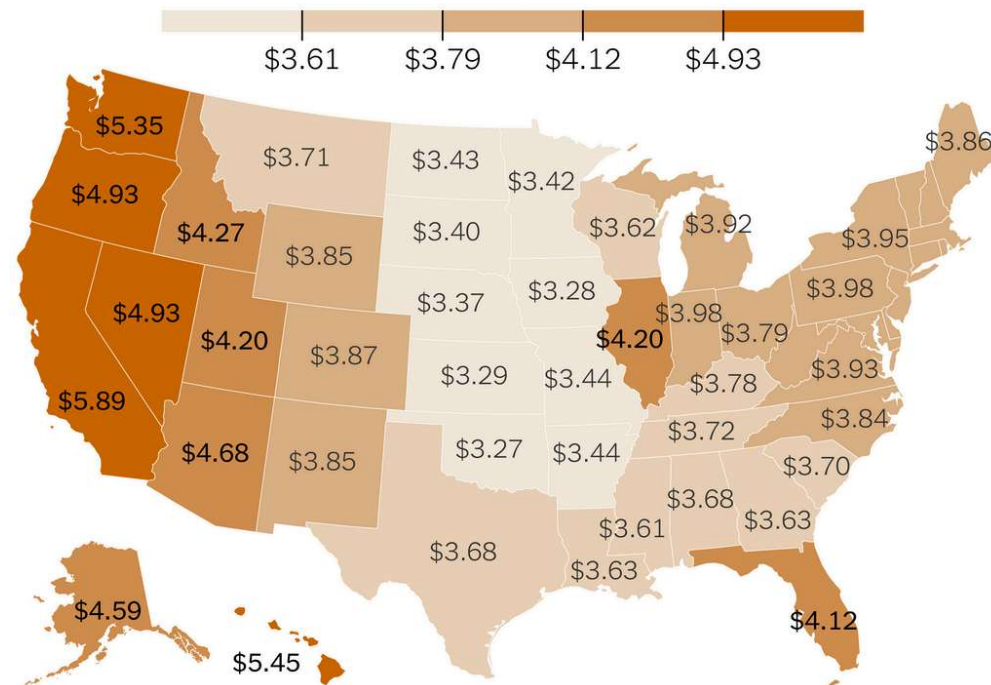
Your pick: The most-clicked link in The Morning yesterday was about [ways to improve brain health](#).

TODAY'S NUMBER

\$5.89

— That was the average price of a gallon of gas in California yesterday.
[Explore gas prices where you live.](#)

Regular gasoline prices on Tuesday



Source: AAA. Karl Russell/The New York Times

SPORTS

Golf: Tiger Woods announced that he would [“seek treatment”](#) after a D.U.I. arrest last week, which means he will miss the Masters.

Soccer: Italy [failed to qualify for the World Cup](#) after losing to Bosnia and Herzegovina on penalties.

RECIPE OF THE DAY

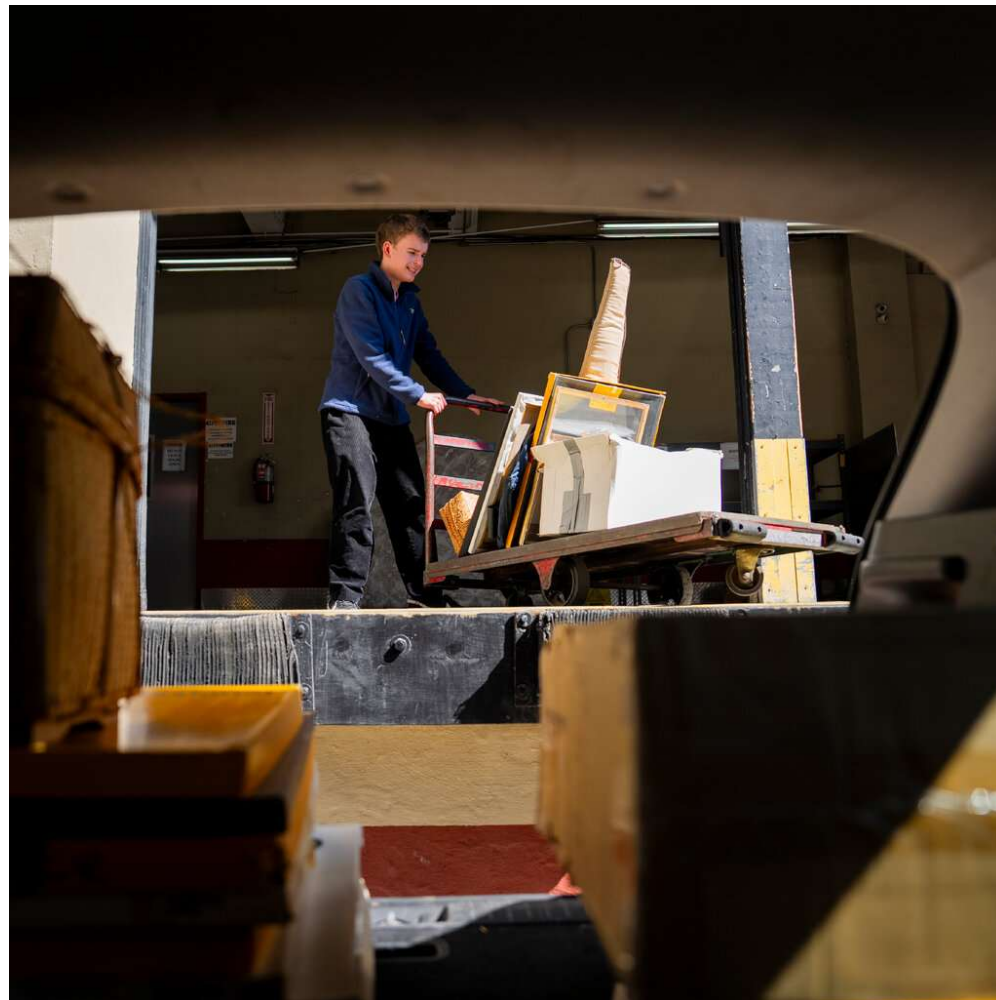


Michael Graydon & Nikole Herriott for The New York Times

Here's an unorthodox Passover recipe from Alison Roman for [apples with honey and crushed walnuts](#). It's a renovated haroseth, essentially: a tangy, crunchy salad of ingredients that are usually chopped into a kind of paste. If a crunchy salad haroseth is going to cause problems at your Seder table — haroseth is meant to symbolize the mortar used by enslaved Israelites to build in ancient Egypt — I'd advise making some [olive-oil mashed potatoes](#) to go with

your brisket, lamb or chicken, and calling that the symbolic cement. Whatever you make, this is a great salad.

THE FLIPPER



Michael Haskell loading the contents of an abandoned storage unit into his car. Vincent Alban/The New York Times

Some teenagers play video games after school, go to band practice or build Lego landscapes. Michael Haskell, 17, [buys abandoned storage lockers](#) and sells their contents for profit. “I think he’s learning about human paths, about human nature,” his mother told The Times. “People’s lives are in these lockers.”

More on culture

“The Book of Mormon” is celebrating its 15th laugh-and-gasp-inducing year on Broadway. Jesse Green, a former theater critic for The Times, [revisited it recently](#) and wondered if the show, which has grossed close to \$1 billion over 6,000 performances, “could even be produced today.”

Eurovision, the international song contest, [is coming to Asia](#).

Stephen Colbert [blamed the “Bachelorette” cancellation](#) for high gas prices.

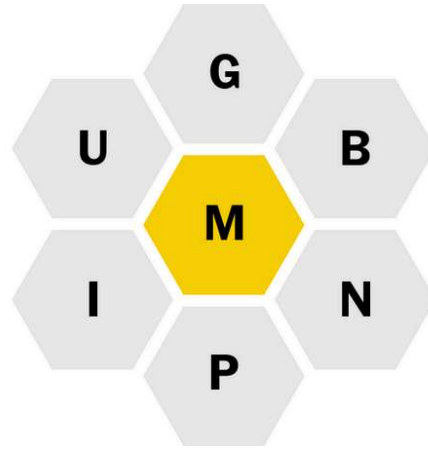
THE MORNING RECOMMENDS

Upgrade your bathroom with [a shower curtain](#) recommended by the opinionated aquaphiles at Wirecutter.

Drink your seltzer with food to [reduce the risk of harm to your teeth](#).

Watch these adorable Labrador retriever puppies jump, one by one, [into a swimming pool](#).

GAMES



Here is [today's Spelling Bee](#). Yesterday's pangram was *cloudily*.

And here are [today's Mini Crossword](#), [Wordle](#), [Connections](#), [Crossplay](#) and [Strands](#).

***Thanks for spending part of your morning with The Times and me.
See you tomorrow. — Sam***

Reach our team at themorning@nytimes.com.



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